

Proposal to the Ohio River Trail Council

Prepared by Experience Design

Boston-Providence

www.expdesign.com

October 10, 2012

Monaca, PA 15061, US

Aliquippa

Carnot-Moon





October 8, 2012

Ohio River Trail Council
1100 Pennsylvania Avenue
Monaca, PA 15061

Dear Vincent Troia and the Selection Team:

Please accept our proposal to perform services for the Ohio River Trail Council. We are an interpretive planning and design studio with 30 years of corporate history providing services in graphic design and exhibition design for non-profit, primarily museum/nature center-type of institutions. Our professional work is designed to take educational content and shape it into visually effective solutions to communicate messages, images and more.

As a studio, we are committed to interpreting our North American ecology and promoting an active appreciation for our waterways. Our earliest interpretive work dates to the development of the content and storyline for many aquariums, including The Texas State Aquarium, the NJ State Aquarium, The Long Beach Aquarium of the Pacific and others. More recently we have designed brochures, trailheads, outdoor signage and websites for a 24-mile bikeway in Maryland, a Trout Hatchery/Wildlife Center with associated walking paths, and a discovery brochure/map for the Mines of Spain Nature Center. We have won many awards for our excellence in design and communication of educational, museum-based interpretation and we offer world-class solutions for all of our clients.

Our firm is led by owner John Carney, with an academic background from Rhode Island School of Design in graphics and industrial design. I provide content and design planning/production and have an academic background from Smith College in education and ecology/biology. I am also a licensed teacher and my skills blend nicely with John's to lead our in-house team in the development of solutions for nature-focused projects. We are avid kayakers and very passionate about preservation and ecological communication. To this end, our skill in communications, content and graphic design, as well as our long-standing experience working with non-profit, ecologically-minded institutions and, our personal passion for your type of project leaves us very well prepared to undertake the scope of work as outlined. We can deliver the entire project with Principal involvement from the first to last meeting and, provide an end product to you by March 31, 2013.

We are very hopeful that our proposal is met with your positive response and that we have the opportunity to meet with you in person.

Sincerely,

Larissa Hallgren
Principal
Larissa@expdesign.com
1005 Main Street Suite 2130
Pawtucket, RI 02860
t. 401 305 3235





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Cost Breakdown

2.1 Compile and Review Existing Information and Base Maps:

Total Cost: \$12,000

Profit (10%): \$900

Direct Expense: Travel/Boating Study: \$3000

Overhead: \$4050

Salary: \$4050

Hourly Rates: John Carney: \$150/hour; Larissa Hallgren: \$120/hour, Graphic Designers: \$90/hr. Researchers: \$70/hr.

2.2 Prepare Base Maps for the Map/Guide

Total Cost: \$8,000

Profit (10%): \$800

Overhead: \$3600

Salary: \$3600

Hourly Rates: John Carney: \$150/hour; Larissa Hallgren: \$120/hour, Graphic Designers: \$90/hr. Researchers: \$70/hr.

2.3 Preparation of Water Trail Map & Guide (including logo design)

Total Cost: \$15,000

Profit (10%): \$1500

Overhead: \$6750

Salary: \$6750

Hourly Rates: John Carney: \$150/hour; Larissa Hallgren: \$120/hour, Graphic Designers: \$90/hr. Researchers: \$70/hr.

2.4 Printing costs

As these are stated as a possible scope only, we pass on providing a quote for a printed product. Instead, if hired, we would for no additional costs, coordinate a printer local to your site that you elect to work with (or we could help recommend).



Interpretive experiences created for the St. Lucie River Nature Center in Florida.



Interpretive trail we developed also at St. Lucie Nature Center, Florida.



Who We Are, An Overview

Experience Design is a interpretive planning, design and production studio located in both Boston and Providence. Our firm designs experiences that connect visitors to their experience and excites them about history, ecology, geology, and culture. We offer all facets of content planning, writing, content research, experience planning, exhibit design, graphic design, all aspects of multi-media design and production, filming and film production.

Our 8 person firm is led by two Principals, both of which have developed interpretive experiences in print, exhibitry and media for nearly 25 years. John Carney began his career out of Rhode Island School of Design's Industrial Design program and quickly joined Joe Wetzel (now retired), who led what was once the only interpretive design in the country. Larissa Hallgren, our second Principal, started her career also 25 years ago, after graduating from Smith College with a degree in science at the Boston Museum of Science. Like John, she soon joined Joe Wetzel. Together John and Larissa, and under the guidance of the first pre-eminent museum exhibition designer, began their careers in earnest. Since that time, John and Larissa have been working together. For the past 12 years John has owned Experience Design and built a staff well-rooted in museum exhibition planning.

Our scope of services is extremely diverse and includes all aspects of exhibition design, planning, fabrication, and installation.

Today our projects are rooted in American history and natural history. We are passionate about telling stories through well-designed and thoughtfully created print and exhibit experiences and, believe that by sharing our history and heritage through materials that are beautiful and engaging, we can connect the public to interpretation and inspire a shared sense of the future.

We offer:

Interpretive Experience

What sets our firm apart from other design firms is the intellectual underpinning that we bring. We feel strongly that by developing context through content, the visitor experience and the map, brochure or exhibit is made much richer, more vivid and impactful. This philosophy is applied to all of our work: indoors, outdoors, signage, maps, web based documents, brochures, artifacts, hands-on experiences, environmental scale exhibits -- truly all things that we design.

Our work has won many awards for excellence in education and interpretation - not just design. Just this past year we won two awards: one for historical excellence at the Puget Sound Navy Museum and the others, two National Association of Interpretation awards at the Mines of Spain Nature Center in Iowa. We attribute this to our commitment to content. We believe this speaks to our ability to successfully integrate educational stories within exhibit elements which are, in turn, experienced by the user.

- Interpretive services
- Historical research
- Visitor Analysis
- Copy writing
- Graphic design
- Photo research
- Fabrication
- Mount making
- Art installation
- Fossil/geological mount
- Object curatorial selection
- Exhibition design
- Graphic signs
- Interactive exhibit design
- Multi-media design
- Motion graphics
- Software development
- Filming
- Editing of media
- Welding
- Woodworking
- Sculpture
- All aspects of graphic print



Key Personnel-Specific Experience

Our design and planning studio is very well suited to complete the work specified as necessary for the Ohio River Trail. We bring 30 years of identity and interpretive design experience. We are extraordinarily passionate about interpreting recreational opportunities like paddling, biking and more as well as regional ties to local ecology, history, and preservation steps. We have developed and designed projects with large, overarching themes of connecting recreational users to regional ecology, biology, as well as history and culture for clients like the Three Notch Bike Trail, The Mines of Spain Visitor Center, Fundy Geological Museum, Pequest Trout History and NJ Fish and Wildlife Center, as well as Switzer Park in the Canadian National Forests. Our largest client group is composed of organizations that like you, are collaborating with a host of other entities who collectively, wish to provide visitor services, orientation and interpretation of a special region which is conveyed through visual materials that is personal, relevant, and provides a "sense of place".

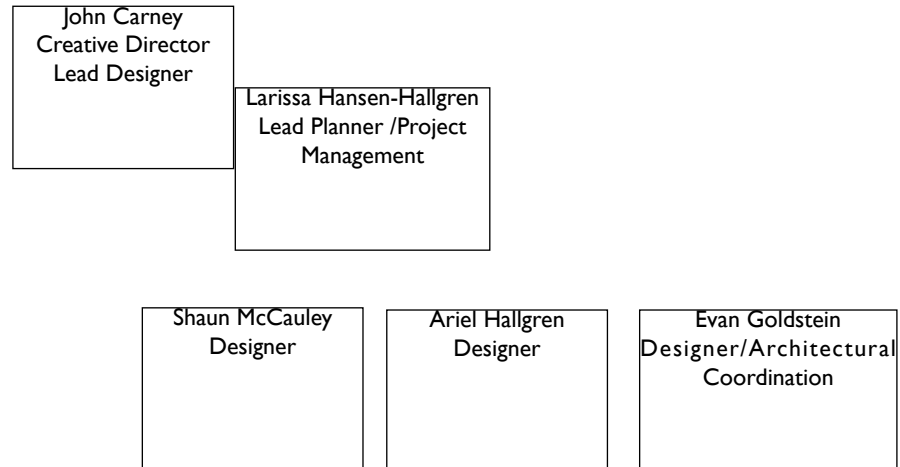
Our talent and expertise lies in our ability to take content and the goals of the overall group to create a compelling storyline for users. We then use this storyline to weave together an experience in a place (like a river or a bike trail!) that will engage and excite.

To complete our work of designing innovative and exciting experiences, we draw from the history of the design studio: 30 years. This, blended with the experience of the key staff, two Principals John Carney and Larissa Hansen Hallgren, we bring talent in all areas of interpretive planning and design. Mr. Carney's projects are all rooted in a proven process that produces success, clear milestones for review, and an integration between interpretative storyline and successful exhibit design. For this project, he will serve as Principal In Charge.

Ms. Hallgren has a degree from Smith College and has completed graduate work in education. Like John, she has spent most of her 25 year career working in private museum firms, 18 of which years have been with John. She is the primary content and interpretive planner, and will conduct all research and content development, coordinates all aspects of design, prepare media drawings/storyboards and, manage the bid set process from our end. Larissa has provided overall design oversight, written interpretive plans, copy, and provided media production and oversight for interactive media and multiple films for museums and visitor centers. Both John and Larissa are adept managers and provide bid oversight and construction administration. Most recently we performed these services for Texas A&M's new museum on agricultural history, Maryland's 3-Notch Trail and, the Louisiana State Museum.



Organizational Chart: Project Team



Of note, we are avid kayakers! Every member of our team is dedicated to ecological explorations via waterway.... to the left is a kayak John Carney built by hand for himself. We all kayak often and truly love to share our own personal passion for ecological conservation and preservation through our professional work.



Resumes for Reference



John Carney
CEO
Creative Director

Trained at Rhode Island School of Design and Basel School of Design in Switzerland, Mr. Carney leads his firm composed of 10 staff in the development of museum design solutions. Serving as Creative Director, he oversees all aspects of the planning for visitor-centered experiences in museums, visitor centers, nature centers and, a host of other visitor-centered destinations. John has created hundreds of museum installations and has also provided planning for the economic structuring and development of museum institutions in the planning phase. Further, John brings 25 years of experience to construction planning, fabrication and oversight.

Today, John is the founder of Experience Design, a firm with three sub-groups: museum planning and exhibition design, fabrication/build, and multi-media design and production. His role as Creative Director enables him to weave together all facets of museum design and ultimately deliver exhibit installations that are inspiring to visitors of all ages, backgrounds, and learning styles.

EXPERIENCE 1998–present

Experience Design, Inc. (formerly Krent/Pallett/Carney Inc.)

Notable projects include:

Josiah Henson Special Park Interpretive and Exhibit Planning

Heritage Museum and Gardens, design & branding

Reid Park Zoo, 2012, design-build interactive and interpretive exhibits

Minnesota Zoo, 2011, design-build children's space and penguin interpretive exhibits

Texas A&M Museum, 2011, design and production of exhibits and multi-media, 3000 sq. ft.

US Navy Museum, Puget Sound, 2011, design, media production, and build, 3000 sq. ft.

Heritage Harbor Master Plan, 2011

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston Museum, 2011, design, media, and project oversight,

Denver Art Museum, interpretive graphics and interactive media, MUSE Award winner 2011

MetLife Corporate Museum, NY, 2011, design and media production

Millennium Pharmaceuticals Corporate Center, 2011, design

Fundy Geological Museum, 2010, design, media production and build 3500 sq. ft.

Louisiana State Museum, Hurricane Katrina Exhibition, 2010, 7000 sq. ft.

Holocaust Resource Center and Museum, 2010-2012, design, media production and build

The State Museum of Pennsylvania, 2009, Master Plan and Design

The Bermuda Underwater Exploration Institute, 2007

Northern Forest Center, 2007, design and media

1986–1998

Joseph A. Wetzel Associates

Served as Lead Designer on projects such as:

El Portal Tropical Forest Center

The Birmingham Civil Rights Institute

The National Jazz Museum



AWARDS

Art Director's Guild, 82nd Annual 2003 Distinctive Merit Award, Mary Baker Eddy Library,

Hall of Ideas, Industrial Design Excellence Award, Birmingham Civil Rights Institute, Best Museum

Environment, MUSE Award for Denver Art Museum 2011 and NAI award for Mines of Spain 2011.

Washington Museum Association Award of Exhibit Excellence, US Navy Museum 2012.

EDUCATION

Rhode Island School of Design, Bachelor of Fine Art, focus on Art, Architecture, and Industrial Design

Studied Art and Graphic Design at Switzerland's Schule für Gestaltung Basel



Larissa Hansen Halgren

COO
Museum Planner/Producer

Larissa's focus is to lead the development of museum-based visitor experiences that engage the widest possible audience and incorporates the broadest possible range of inspiring exhibit techniques. She considers the best way to spark the guests' curiosity, provide relevance, and create an experience with meaning by becoming immersed in the content, understanding the visitor, and ultimately creating exhibit solutions. She is adept at considering the relationship between indoor and outdoor experiences and, integrating opportunities for placemaking, wayfinding, and providing appropriate visitor amenities which in turn, ultimately makes for a holistic visitor experience.

Rooted in content, Larissa has a degree from Smith College and masters work in education. Today, her work at Experience Design is focused on the development of powerful exhibit experiences that celebrate our American history or explore our living world through science. As the senior project planner, she facilitates all aspects of a project from community workshops, client contact, design direction, production oversight and, multi-media production ensuring all projects are built to the client's expectations, on time, and on budget.

Larissa has developed hundreds of museum projects, most notably with work receiving recognition through the National Association of Interpretation in 2011 (2 awards). She expects to NAI certification in 2011, has experience equivalent with NPS Professional Minimum Qualification Standards 36CFR6/historian, and is a licensed Massachusetts teacher.

EXPERIENCE

2008-present
Experience Design, Inc. (formerly Krent/Pallett/Carney Inc.)

Notable projects include:

Joshua Henson Special Park, MD

Heritage Museum and Gardens, Norman Rodowall Exhibition,

Reid Park Zoo, 2012, design-build interactive and interpretive exhibits

Plymouth Plantation, 2012, interpretive design and site map design

Minnesota Zoo, 2011, design-build children's space and penguin interpretive exhibits

Texas A&M Museum, 2011, design and production of exhibits and multi-media, 3000 sq. ft.

Hancock Shaker Village, design-build interactive and interpretive Anniversary exhibit

Heritage Harbor Master Plan, content planning 2011

Denver Art Museum, interpretive graphics and interactive media, MUSE Award winner 2011

Millennium Pharmaceuticals Corporate Center, 2011, design

Fundy Geological Museum, 2010, design, media production and build 3500 sq. ft.

Louisiana State Museum, 2010, Hurricane Katrina Exhibition, 7000 sq. ft.



2005-2008

Massachusetts Middle School Teacher

Developed and implemented curricula and instruction in science and math for grades 5 math and science for the gifted and talented. Lic. grades 5-8 in science (physical and life).

1990-1999

Joseph A. Wetzel Associates

Long Beach Aquarium of the Pacific

The Antwerp Zoo

The Seattle Aquarium Master Plan

The Taiwan Aquarium

Shedd Aquarium Master Plan

California Museum of Science and Industry's *Worlds Beyond* and *World of the Pacific*.

1989-1991

Museum of Science

Devised hands-on interactives for special visiting exhibitions.

Bachelor of Arts, Smith College

University of Texas, El Paso, desert ecology studies

Graduate Work, University of Connecticut and Bridgewater State College, science education



EDUCATION



Key Projects

1) Mines of Spain, Iowa

Nestled in a large park, this visitor center has many facets. We designed a compelling brochure that provides both interpretation about the region and references to history, ecology, geology and archaeology. It is intended to prompt users to “get outside” and leave the visitor center in order to explore the world around them. This client also asked us to design associated exhibitions that entailed 2,000 square feet in total. We won two National Association of Interpretation Awards for this work.



2) Fundy Geological Museum, Canada

Located in the Bay of Fundy we were asked to design and deliver 3,000 square feet of interpretive exhibits in the form of graphics and environments. We also created an exhibition and associated brochures that encouraged people to continue outside of the museum and on to an exploration of the beaches, estuaries and other locations where water has eroded the landscape and revealed geological and paleontological highlights of the local past.





3) Heritage Museum and Gardens, Massachusetts

Recently we undertook the design and development of a new brand/identity for a traveling exhibition that we designed. The logo was used on all facets of the projects' marketing materials—from ticketing, ad campaigns, branded materials in the gift shop, exhibits and more.



4) National Constitution Center

We were honored with two projects awarded to us at this site. One was to develop a 3,000 square foot exhibition that featured Lincoln and the Civil War and the second, also 3,000 square feet was entitled Headed To The White House, which focused on what it entailed to run for President. Our work in both instances entailed designing and producing the content, storyline, script, all exhibit elements, graphics and media production for 2,000 square feet. We also created all the identity and logo materials used for both exhibitions.



EXP designed the website splash page (above) as well as the exhibits, brochures and educational teacher materials.



5. Three Notch Bike Trail

Located in Maryland, we designed and developed both a trail map, a brochure that is printable off the web and 24 interpretive trail markers that both get users on their bikes and cycling and, promote an understanding of nature and history. Of particular note is the underlying emphasis in “how” to explore without disturbing.





6. Pequest Fish & Wildlife Center

We just completed the design and installation of exhibits that are intended to promote a visitor's understanding of the ecology of New Jersey and, how to enjoy, preserve and protect it. We created a number of interpretive opportunities from graphics to environments as well as interactive multi-media complete with maps that invite one to explore various regions by foot or watercraft, so to discover the ecology. The storyline features the diversity of wildlife, its precious nature and, how to explore while preserving and leaving "no trace".





7. St. Lucie River Interpretive Center, Florida

We designed a series of hands-on interpretive exhibits that included many maps, and which highlighted the special ecology and fragile nature of the St. Lucie River. In addition, we researched--via boat--the river to better understand its special qualities, ecology and biology. Along the way we filmed many aspects and created a multi-media installation along with the other exhibits.





7. Crane Point, Florida

With a host of interpretive maps and opportunities, we brought to life a 9 mile trail at the Crane Brook Nature Center, Florida. Associated, downloadable pdf was available via the website. All the content was focused on stories of ecological preservation and conservation, with a strong message of “leave no trace”.

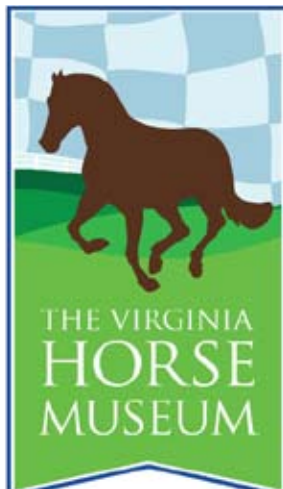




Current Workload

Experience Design is under contract with the following clients to develop design solutions:

- Newport Mansion Visitor Center. New building and center, project involves exhibit and media design and production. To be completed Spring 2014.
- Josiah Henson Museum and Visitor Center/ Special Park. Conversion of historic house into a visitor center, site into focused interpretation of archaeological evidence of slave occupation. To be completed Spring 2014.
- NOAA Gulf of the Farallones Interpretive Center. Completed Fall 2012.
- Switzer Park Visitor Center, Canada, Completed Fall 2012.
- Pequest Visitor Center, NJ. Punch list completion in progress.



Logo we designed for the new Virginia Museum of the Horse. Currently used to lead a campaign that is almost complete, targeting \$9 million for construction.

65' long wall at Takapausha Nature Center featured tanks, objects and graphics focused on wetlands, riparian zones and freshwater resources.

